Good Afternoon

Today is Monday, March, 16, 1981, the 75th day of the year. There are 290 days remaining in 1981.

Tomorrow's weather will be much warmer, increasing high clouds, northwest winds. Complete weather, Page A-2.

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GREATER OAKLAND EDITION

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State warning on prestressed concrete

By Virgil Meibert
Tribune Sacramento Bureau

The State Architect's office issued a statewide alert today that hazardous conditions may exist in prestressed concrete buildings throughout California.

Based on a year-long study of the roof collapse at the Antioch High School auditorium last March, the state said other similarly constructed buildings may be in danger of "a precipitous failure."

Last year, the state ordered Park Junior High School in Antioch, King Junior High School gymnasium in Oakland and the athletic field bleachers at McClymonds High School in Oakland either closed or shored up.

Antioch Superintendent Jerry Pangburn said today that the junior high school there still is closed pending approval by the state architects of a $700,000 project to strengthen it.

In Oakland, the gym at King Junior High still is padlocked, but the bleachers at McClymonds were reinforced with heavy timber so they could be used during the 1980 football season. Oakland school board member Russell Bruno said that plans for correcting the problems also are before the state architects for approval.

Bruno said he is hopeful that the state will help to pay for the corrections said did in Antioch.

Today's formal alert, issued to architects, contractors and building owners, recommends expert examination of all precast concrete buildings for signs of structural distress.

Chief of structural safety Donald Jephcott said buildings of the same design as Antioch High School may have developed similar hazardous conditions which could cause a collapse either during an earthquake or "normal gravity."

Jephcott said that most of the prestressed concrete buildings found by the state with problems were built in the 1950s and early 1960s.

He said the danger of roof collapse occurs

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Battle looms over business property tax increase plan

By Ken Gepfert
Los Angeles Times

Tom Hannigan has a nightmare about Proposition 13.

Two neighbors — one a recent arrival to the neighborhood — are having a couple of drinks while enjoying a backyard barbecue. The subject of property taxes comes up. The recent arrival discovers that because of Proposition 13, he is paying three times more in taxes than his neighbor even though he has a nearly identical house.

Incensed and intoxicated, the newcomer rushes inside, grabs his gun, and . . .

"It hasn't quite gotten to that point," the Democratic assemblyman from Fairfield concedes, but Hannigan is worried that California is inviting at least another taxpayers' revolt unless lawmakers remedy what he calls a built-in inequity of Proposition 13.

Even proponents of the 1978 tax-cutting initiative, including co-author Paul Gann, acknowledge that it promotes unequal treatment of taxpayers. The inequity arises because the voter-approved law sharply limits tax increases on property owners who don't move, while allowing often-hefty jumps in levies owed by those who move or build a new home.

But Hannigan's solution to this problem is generating even more controversy than the inequity it seeks to correct.

The solution is called a "split roll," which means that businesses would be taxed more than residences to finance the cost of equalizing homeowners' property tax bills. In the first year alone, it would generate an estimated $2.6 billion in new taxes from business property owners.

Moreover, Hannigan's proposal to split tax assessment "rolls" into two categories would generate hundreds of millions of dollars in new state revenue, again at the expense of California business.

Business leaders have launched an all-out assault, arguing the split roll is designed to prevent state budget cutbacks by imposing a "hidden tax" on all

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Frederick Hubbell joins parents in Frankfurt, Germany, today. AP

Rep. Long, El Salvador chief meet

Associated Press

SAN SALVADOR, El Salvador — The chairman of a House subcommittee considering President Reagan's request for more military aid to El Salvador met here today with the president of this nation's ruling junta.

Rep. Clarence Long, D-Md., arrived in San Salvador on a two-day fact-finding visit and was briefed by U.S. Embassy officials before meeting with junta President Jose Napoleon Duarte.

He was scheduled to lunch with Salvadoran business leaders then consult with church and military officials.

In Washington, Long's administrative assistant, Timothy Kernan, said the congressman wants to discuss the effect here of increased U.S. military aid and the presence of American military advisers. He also hoped to discuss progress toward land reform, allegations of terrorism by rightists and government forces

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U.S. hints Soviets aided hijack

Associated Press

WASHINGTON — The State Department said today Soviet and Afghan authorities may have aided the 13-day hijacking of a Pakistani jetliner by providing weapons to the hijackers while the plane was on the ground at Kabul airport.

Citing what he said were eyewitness accounts, Department spokesman William Dyess said the three hijackers were armed with pistols on arrival in Kabul but left with machine guns.

The hijacking ended on Saturday, when the three Pakistanis surrendered to Syrian authorities in Damascus and freed more than 100 hostages in exchange for the release of Pakistani political prisoners.

Recounting the events at Kabul airport, Dyess said, "I don't see how the Soviets can escape responsibility for what took place."

He said the hijackers appeared to be under little pressure from local authorities during their stay of more than a week in Kabul. At one point, Dyess said, the hijackers were seen fraternizing with Afghan and Soviet authorities in full view of eyewitnesses.

Under questioning, Dyess refused to speculate on what motives the Soviets and the Afghans might have had in their alleged cooperation with the hijackers.

Dyess also said the Soviets did not condemn the hijacking for 10 days after it occurred and and made no serious effort to end the incident.

"We find that strange. We find that unusual," Dyess said.

He added that given the Soviet military occupation of Afghanistan, it would not be unreasonable to expect the Soviets to condemn the incident.

Meanwhile, the Moslems among the 101 freed hostages flew to Saudi Arabia today for a two-day thanksgiving at Islam's holy shrines. One of the Americans who suffered through the 13-day ordeal said the killing of a Pakistani diplomat-hostage may have been accidental.

The drug suspect, Page A-6

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Inch of rain; more possible

By Susan Shoemaker
Tribune Staff Writer

Skies cleared today, but the weatherman warned that the rain might return Tuesday.

A nippy winter storm dumped almost an inch of rain on most parts of the Bay Area Sunday, causing the usual traffic snarls for motorists brave enough to venture out in it.

By 4 p.m. Sunday, the storm had dropped .85 inches of rain on downtown Oakland and .82 inches at the airport.

"It was a pretty good rain,"

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Passenger stops assault on an AC Transit driver

BERKELEY — A 35-year-old man was arrested here early Sunday and accused of attacking a female AC Transit bus driver.

He was thrown off the bus by a passenger, police said.

Driver Barbara Marcellus had been punched repeatedly by Victor J. Young just after 7 a.m. but refused hospital care, according to Sgt. Larry Plummer.

Young, whose regular address is unknown, boarded the Line 51 bus with an invalid transfer at Dana Street and Bancroft Way, according to Plummer. Marcellus refused the transfer, asked for a fare, and was told by Young that he didn't have any money and that he wouldn't leave the bus, Plummer said.

Marcellus radioed AC Transit security officers, who told her to drive to Shattuck Avenue and Center Street to await aid.

While the bus was stopped there, Young allegedly tried to snatch a handful of bus transfers and started punching Marcellus.

A passenger went to her aid, Plummer said, physically throwing Young off the bus. The officer would not identify the passenger.

Young then caught a taxi, which was traced by police and located in downtown Oakland with Young inside. He now faces a felony assault charge, Plummer said.

Charlotte Hubbell
Ex-hostage still looks stunned

Two men with key roles in fate of Reagan budget

By John H. Averill and Paul Houston
Los Angeles Times

WASHINGTON — Pete Domenici thought he had a glittering future as a baseball pitcher when he led his American Legion team in Albuquerque to the New Mexico state championship and later averaged more than a dozen strikeouts in the college game.

But the fast-balling right-hander bombed out in the minor leagues when a batter smashed a line drive so hard that it splintered a wooden fence in deep center field. "You damned wild rookie," the manager screamed, handing Domenici $10 for a hammer and nails to "fix that fence they destroyed on you."

Back in 1965, a young Army lieutenant named Jim Jones visited the White House for a job interview with Jack Valenti, then a top aide to President Lyndon B. Johnson and now the chief lobbyist for the motion picture industry.

"This unprepossessing man appeared," Valenti recalled. "He was quiet, not at all charismatic, and yet there was something about him that I found strikingly attractive — a nice confident air without being arrogant." Valenti remembers telling Johnson, "He doesn't look like a leader, but there's a lot of steel inside him."

Today, the former lieutenant, who became one of Johnson's top aides, is Rep. James R. Jones, D-Okla., the new chairman of the House Budget Committee. The heckless right-hander, now a U.S. senator from New Mexico, is the newly installed chairman of the

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Berkeley police are getting into politics

By Martin Halstuk
Tribune Staff Writer

BERKELEY — A new political force, the police, has entered the political arena here.

It is being done more out of necessity than out of desire, says the group's leader, Officer Dennis Cataleta.

"The city couldn't do any more to hurt us than it already has," said Cataleta, president of the Berkeley Police Association, which recently voted to remove bylaws that have in the past barred police from becoming actively involved in city politics.

Noting that the police staff has been steadily decreasing over the last 10 years while workloads have been stubbornly rising, Cataleta said the association concluded the only way to halt the erosion would be to try direct influence.

Sometime before the end of the month, the association will endorse a slate of candidates in the April 21 City Council election in which four seats will be filled.

"We know these are austere times with the impact of Proposition 13, and the city's financial picture is tough," Cataleta said. "But we feel like we're second-class citizens."

Cataleta said the city's attitude toward police protection is not "malicious — it's just off target. They (council members) don't see the city's needs the way we do."

An association survey shows the department's total staff, sworn officers and civilians, has gradually declined since 1970 from 277 to 236. Of this number the sworn police staff dropped from 213 to 164.

Although the number of major crimes has remained fairly stable (about 13,000 annually) the number of total reports

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